Camilo Pedraza Jiménez

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Profile

PhD Candidate at the Hertie School, where I completed two master's degrees in Public Policy and Data Science. Economist and Political Scientist from Universidad de los Andes (Colombia). Skilled in public policy evaluation and data science. Experienced in public affairs and research, with a special interest in applying data science techniques (e.g., causal inference, geospatial analysis, machine learning, and deep learning) to support sustainable development and environmental protection.

Education

Sep. 2025 – Present
Ph.D. Governance - Computational Social Science, Hertie School.
Research Focus: Application of data science techniques (e.g., causal inference, geospatial analysis, machine learning, and deep learning) to support sustainable development and environmental protection.
Main Supervisors: Prof. Asya Magazinnik, Prof. Drew Dimmery.

Sep. 2023 – Jun. 2025
M.Sc. Data Science, Hertie School.
Thesis title: *Seeing the Forest through the trees: Exploring Deforestation Trends in Colombia with Machine Learning*.

Sep. 2022 – Jun. 2024
M.Sc. Public Policy, Hertie School.
Thesis title: *A Forest Call: Impact Evaluation of the Colombian Peace Agreement from 2016 on Deforestation*.

Sep. 2016 – Jun. 2021
B.A. Political Science, Universidad de los Andes.

Jan. 2016 – Dic. 2020
B.A. Economics, Universidad de los Andes.

Work Experience

Jan. 2026 – Present
Teaching Assistant, Hertie School.
Teaching Assistant to courses for the Master's in Data Science for Public Policy: Causal Inference, Math for Data Science.

Jun. 2026 – Aug. 2026
Applied Data Scienctist (internship), Probabl.
Author and co-author of 3 scientific blog posts on agentic data science.

Jul. 2025 – Dec. 2025
Researcher, RWI – Leibniz Institute for Economic Research.
Member of the INFECTIONS project: Management of survey panel data from the DHS program across several African countries.

May 2023 – Mar. 2025
Student Research Assistant, DIW – German Institute for Economic Research.
Member of the Climate Policy Department: Literature review and data analysis for research focused on energy markets. Member of the Firms and Markets Unit: Analysis of data on subsidies for companies in the U.S.

Oct. 2024 – Feb. 2025
Research Associate, Hertie School.
Research Associate to Prof. Asya Magazinnik: Research on housing permits across different U.S. cities.

Sep. 2021 – May 2023
Junior Researcher, WifOR Institute.
Member of the Health Economy and Business Development Teams: Research on the effects of regulatory measures of 6 Latin American Countries during the COVID-19 pandemic. Support on the communication process with different potential business partners.

Publications

Working Papers

2026 **Estimating the Impact of the Expansion of Protected Areas on Forest Loss in Colombia.**

Reports and Scientific Posts

2026 **Data deep dive #2: Which AI agents are data scientists using and at which stages of their workflows?**
Probabl Blog. Post

2026 **Data deep dive #1: Scikit-learn was downloaded 2B times in the last year. Is AI driving this boom?**
Probabl Blog. Post

2022 **COVID-19 Policy Environment and the Importance of Health Economy in Latin America.**
WifOR Institute. Report for FIFARMA. Report

Skills

Languages	Spanish (native), English (fluent), German (fluent), French (Basic).
Coding	Python, R, STATA.
Additional Tools	Microsoft Office, LaTeX, Html, Tableau.
Quantitative Skills	Causal inference, Machine/Deep Learning, Geospatial Analysis, NLP.

Additional Experience

Certificates and Achievements

2025 **PhD Stipend,** Hertie School.

2025 **Participation Certificate,** DataFest 2025 at the LMU Munich.

2024 **Data Science Thesis Winner 2024,** Data Science Lab at the Hertie School.

2022 **COLFUTURO-DAAD Scholarship,** Fundación COLFUTURO.

2018 **Erasmus+ Scholarship,** European Union.

Academic Activity

2022 – 2025 **Hertie School**
Board Member of the Hertie Latin American Club.
Board Member of the Bouldering Club.

2018 – 2021 **Universidad de los Andes**
Member of the student magazine "Supuestos".
Member of the Research Hotbed for Regional Political Economy.
Member of the Research Hotbed for Social Science Programming.

Professional Development

2021 **Analytics Projects in Python,**Universidad de los Andes.